

VISUAL & CAPABILITY REFERENCE

AutoCAD Status Bar

Common 2D controls, behavior, and access patterns

34-SLIDE REFERENCE · ENGLISH · AUTODESK SOURCE SCREENSHOTS ONLY

● OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT

18.3613, 6.3297, 0.0000 MODEL # ▾ + L ↻ ▾ ✂ ▾ ↗ ▾ □ ▾ ▴ ▴ ▴ 1:1 ▾ ⚙ ▾ + □ ▾ ☰

Coordinates · drafting aids · annotation · viewport · workspace · customization

Fast state changes, deeper settings one step away

01 Click

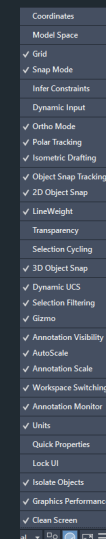
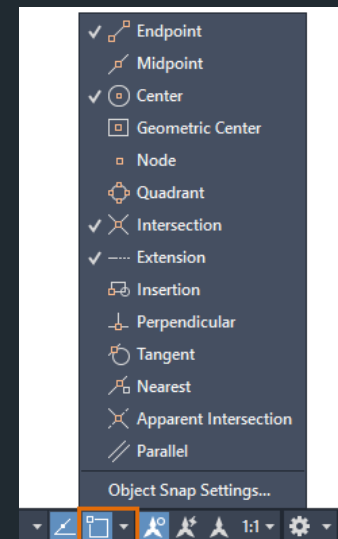
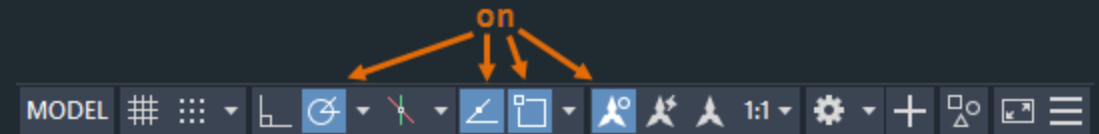
Toggle a drafting aid. A blue background indicates that the feature is on.

02 Open the arrow or right-click

Choose modes or open settings without leaving the drawing context.

03 Customize

Use the rightmost three-line button to decide which controls remain visible.



● ALL THREE VISUALS ARE AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOTS

Coordinates

Displays the cursor position and lets you monitor precise locations while drafting.

HOW IT BEHAVES

The readout can be static or dynamic and can report absolute coordinates or relative polar distance and angle during point entry.



ACCESS

Customization → Coordinates · Ctrl+I cycles display modes

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT

31.5262, 9.1136, 0.0000

Coordinate readout shown in Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Model & Paper Space

Shows whether work is taking place in model space or a paper-space layout.

HOW IT BEHAVES

In a layout viewport, the control switches between editing model geometry and working on the paper layout.



ACCESS

Click MODEL or PAPER in the status bar

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



The two contextual states displayed by AutoCAD

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Grid

Displays a visual grid across the current UCS plane to support alignment and distance judgment.

HOW IT BEHAVES

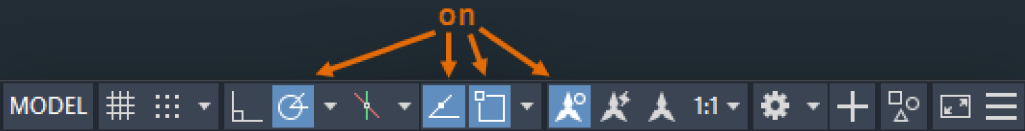
A click toggles the grid. Right-click opens Grid Settings for spacing, subdivisions, and display behavior.



ACCESS

F7 · Right-click → Grid Settings

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Autodesk's Grid Settings status-bar interaction

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Snap Mode

Restricts cursor movement to regular grid intervals or polar-distance increments.

HOW IT BEHAVES

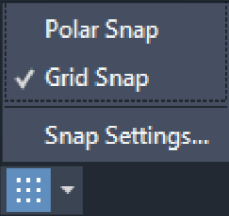
The dropdown chooses Grid Snap or Polar Snap; settings control spacing and snap behavior.



ACCESS

F9 · Right-click → Snap Settings

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Grid Snap and Polar Snap menu from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Infer Constraints

Applies geometric constraints automatically as geometry is created or edited.

HOW IT BEHAVES

When enabled, AutoCAD recognizes relationships such as horizontal, vertical, parallel, perpendicular, tangent, and coincident.



ACCESS

Status-bar toggle · CONSTRAINTINFER system variable

Not available in AutoCAD LT.

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Infer Constraints status icon published by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Dynamic Input

Displays command prompts and editable distance, angle, and coordinate fields beside the cursor.

HOW IT BEHAVES

It keeps attention near the geometry while still accepting precise numeric input and command options.



ACCESS

F12 · DYNMODE · Right-click for settings

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Dynamic Input status icon from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Orthomode

Constrains cursor movement to horizontal or vertical directions.

HOW IT BEHAVES

Use it for fast axis-aligned construction. AutoCAD marks an enabled status control with a blue background.



ACCESS
F8 · ORTHOMODE

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Orthomode icon published in Autodesk's status reference

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Isometric Drafting

Aligns drafting aids to three 120-degree isometric axes for 2D representations of 3D forms.

HOW IT BEHAVES

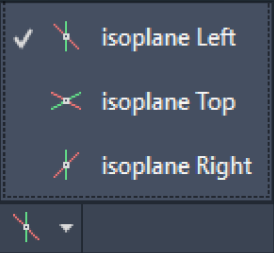
The flyout selects the Left, Top, or Right isoplane; the active isoplane changes snap and crosshair orientation.



ACCESS

F5 or Ctrl+E cycles isoplanes · ISODRAFT

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Isoplane selection menu from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Object Snap Tracking

Tracks alignment paths from acquired object-snap points.

HOW IT BEHAVES

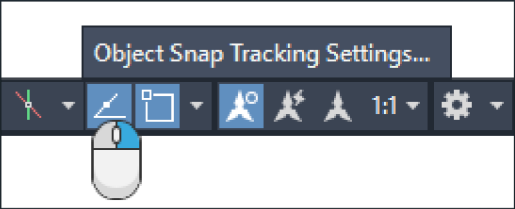
It works with Object Snap and can follow orthogonal or polar alignment paths from temporary acquisition points.



ACCESS

F11 · OTRACK · Right-click for tracking settings

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Object Snap Tracking settings access shown by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



2D Object Snap

Snap the cursor to exact geometric references such as endpoints, midpoints, centers, quadrants, and intersections.

HOW IT BEHAVES

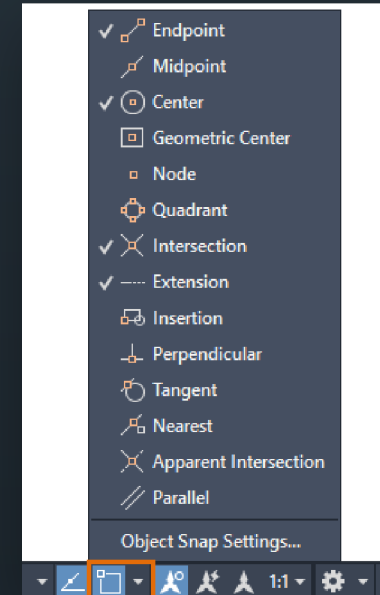
The menu enables running snap modes individually; Object Snap Settings opens the complete configuration.



ACCESS

F3 · OSNAP · Dropdown for running modes

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Running Object Snap checklist from Autodesk Help



LineWeight

Shows assigned lineweights in model space and layouts.

HOW IT BEHAVES

Model space uses proportional pixel widths; layouts preview real-world plotted widths.



ACCESS

LWDISPLAY · Right-click → Lineweight Settings

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT

Lineweight Settings...



Lineweight Settings access shown by Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Transparency

Controls whether non-zero object and layer transparency is displayed in the drawing area.

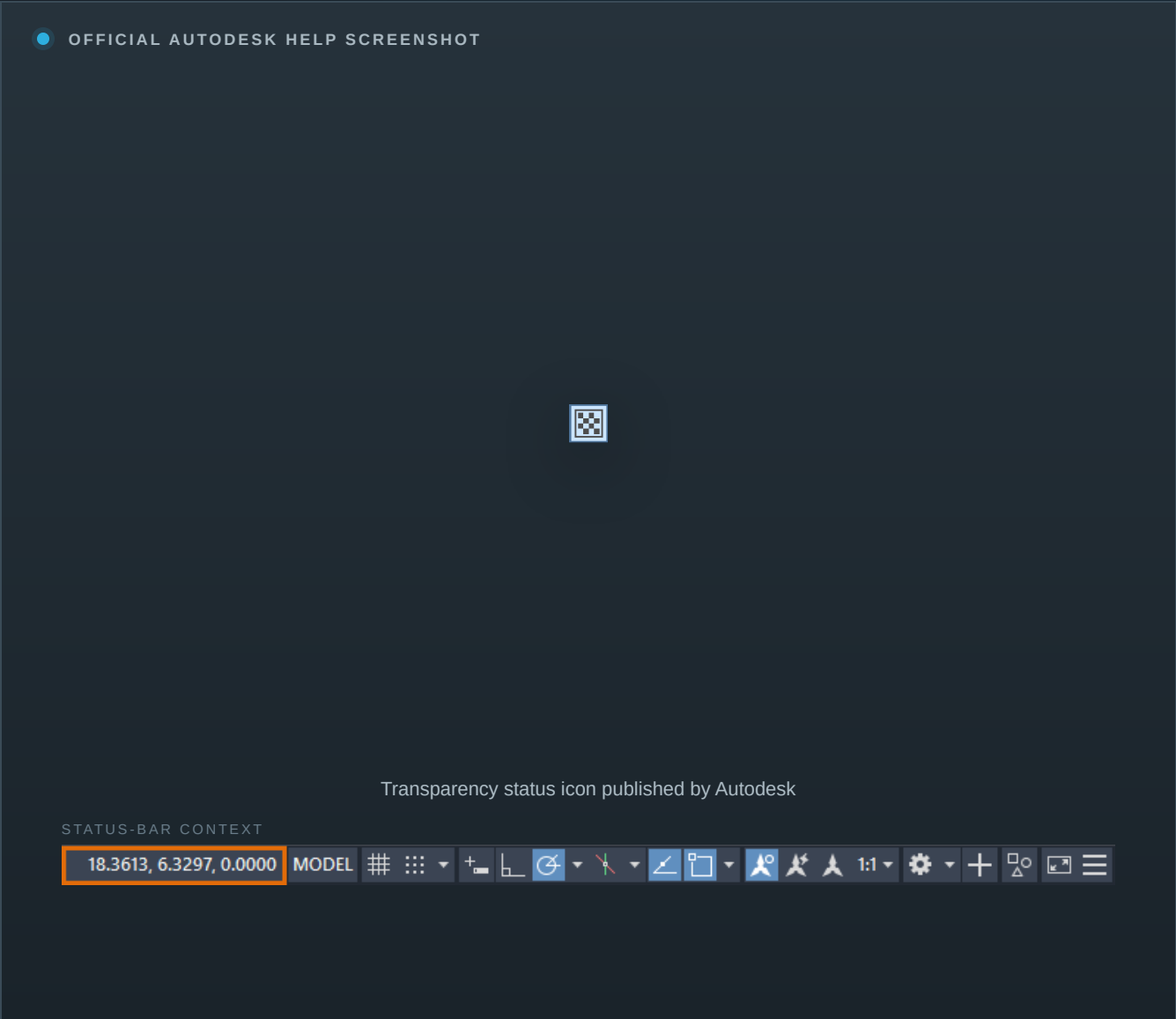
HOW IT BEHAVES

Turning the control off suppresses the transparency effect without changing stored object properties.



ACCESS

TRANSPARENCYDISPLAY



Selection Cycling

Helps select the intended object when two or more objects overlap.

HOW IT BEHAVES

When enabled, clicking overlapping geometry opens a list so the desired object can be identified and selected.



ACCESS

Ctrl+W · SELECTIONCYCLING

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Selection Cycling status icon published by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Maximize & Minimize Viewport

Temporarily expands a layout viewport to fill the drawing area, then restores it to the layout.

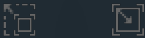
HOW IT BEHAVES

The status icon changes between maximize and minimize states while preserving the viewport boundary and scale context.



ACCESS
VPMAX · VPMIN

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



The paired viewport states published by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Annotation Visibility

Controls whether annotative objects for all scales or only the current annotation scale are visible.

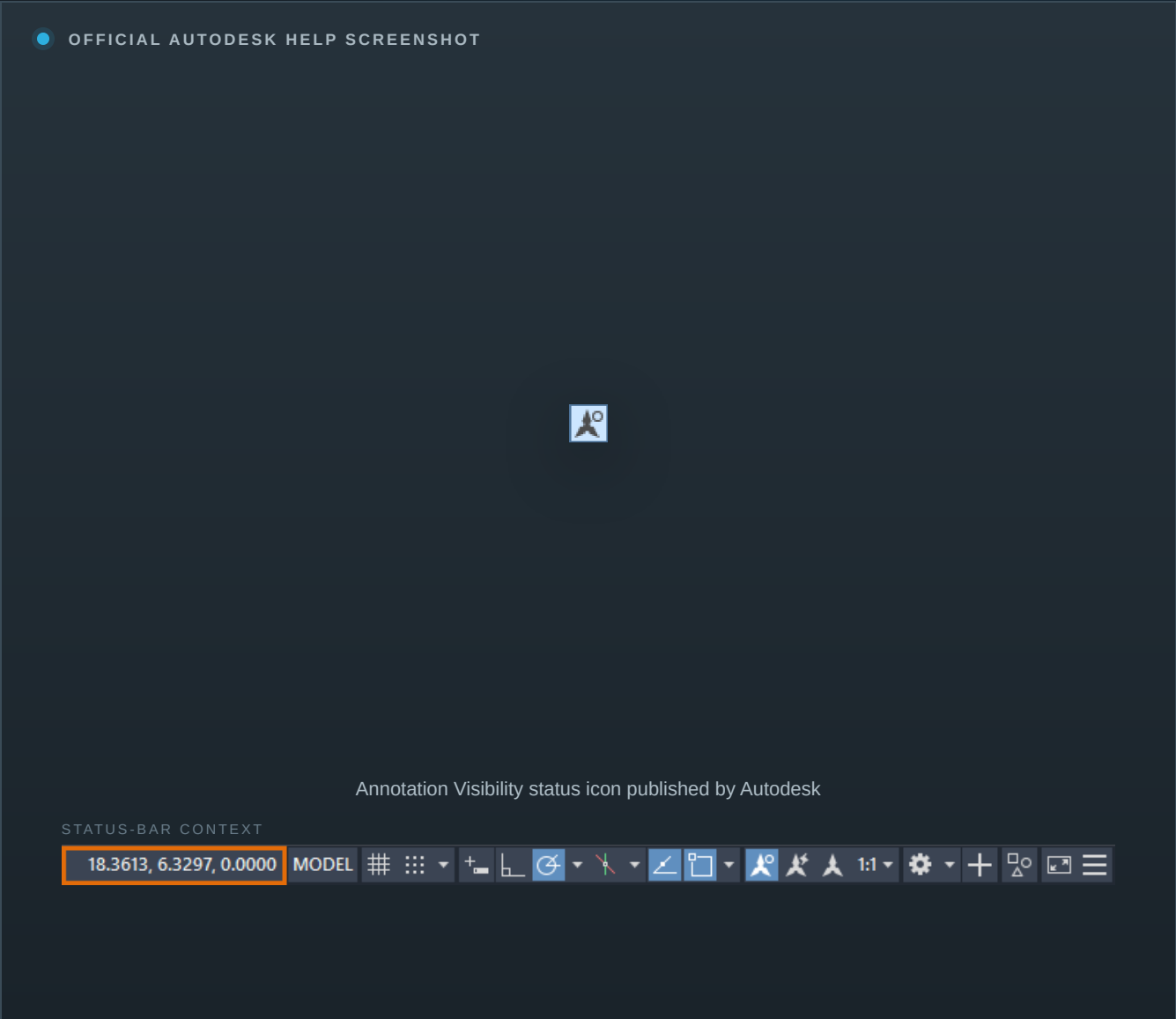
HOW IT BEHAVES

Use it to reveal scale representations while checking or editing annotative content.



ACCESS

ANNOALLVISIBLE



AutoScale

Automatically adds the current annotation scale to annotative objects when the scale changes.

HOW IT BEHAVES

It reduces manual scale maintenance but can add scale representations broadly, so it should be enabled intentionally.



ACCESS
ANNOAUTOSCALE

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



AutoScale status icon published by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Annotation Scale

Sets the current annotation scale for annotative objects in model space.

HOW IT BEHAVES

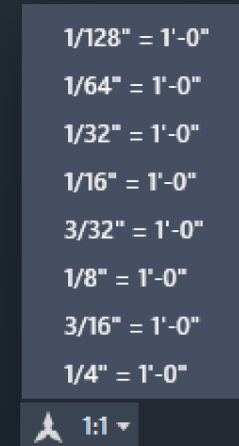
The dropdown exposes saved scales and determines the display size of annotative text, dimensions, and blocks.



ACCESS

CANNOSCALE · Select a scale from the dropdown

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Annotation scale list from Autodesk Help



Viewport Lock

Locks a selected layout viewport's display so accidental zooming does not change its scale.

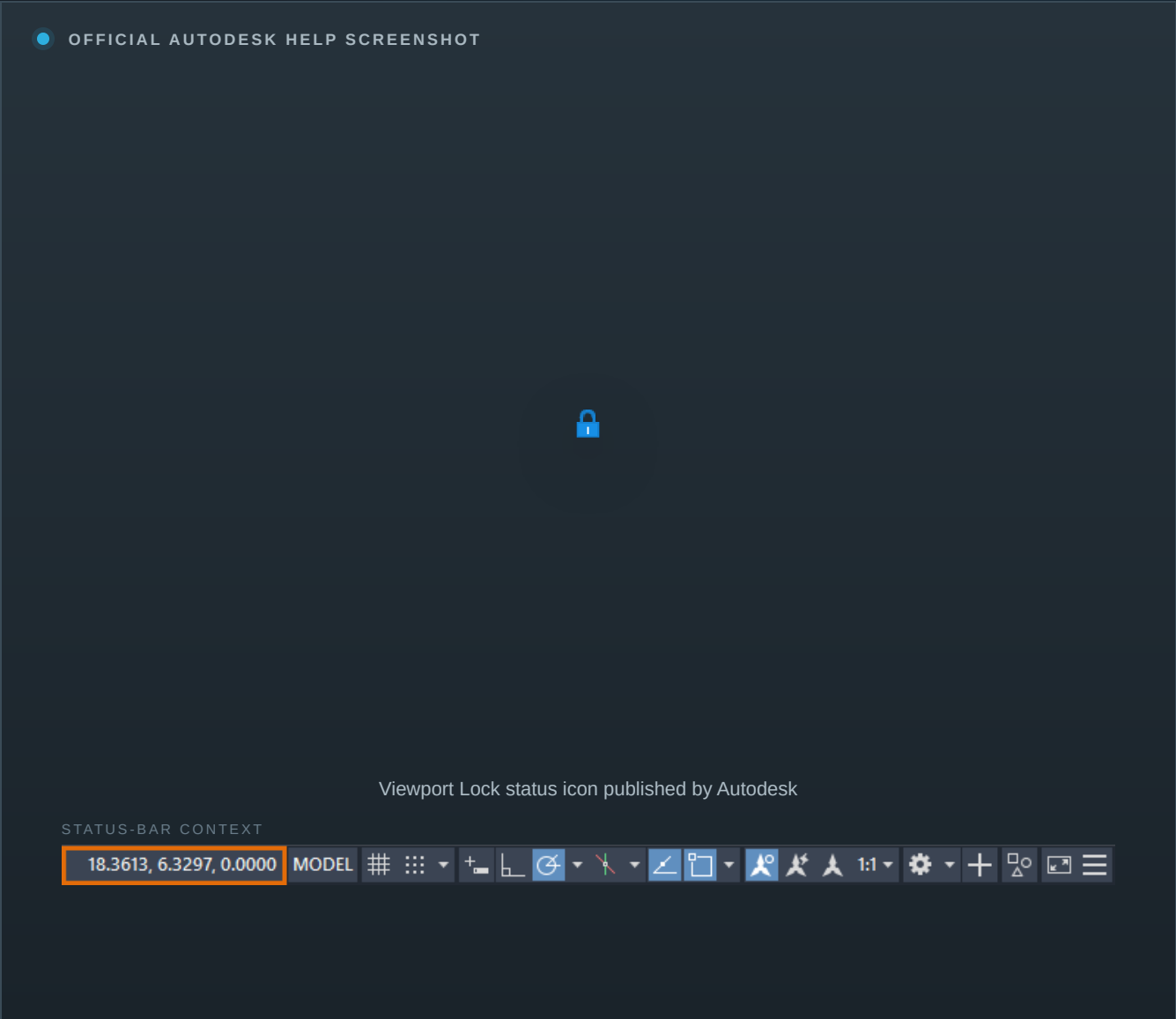
HOW IT BEHAVES

With the viewport locked, wheel zoom applies to the paper layout rather than altering the view inside the viewport.



ACCESS

Select a layout viewport, then click the lock



Viewport Scale

Displays and changes the scale of a selected layout viewport.

HOW IT BEHAVES

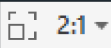
It appears contextually when a viewport is selected and provides direct access to standard viewport scales.



ACCESS

Select a layout viewport → choose scale

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Viewport Scale control shown by Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Viewport Scale Sync

Shows whether viewport scale and annotation scale are synchronized.

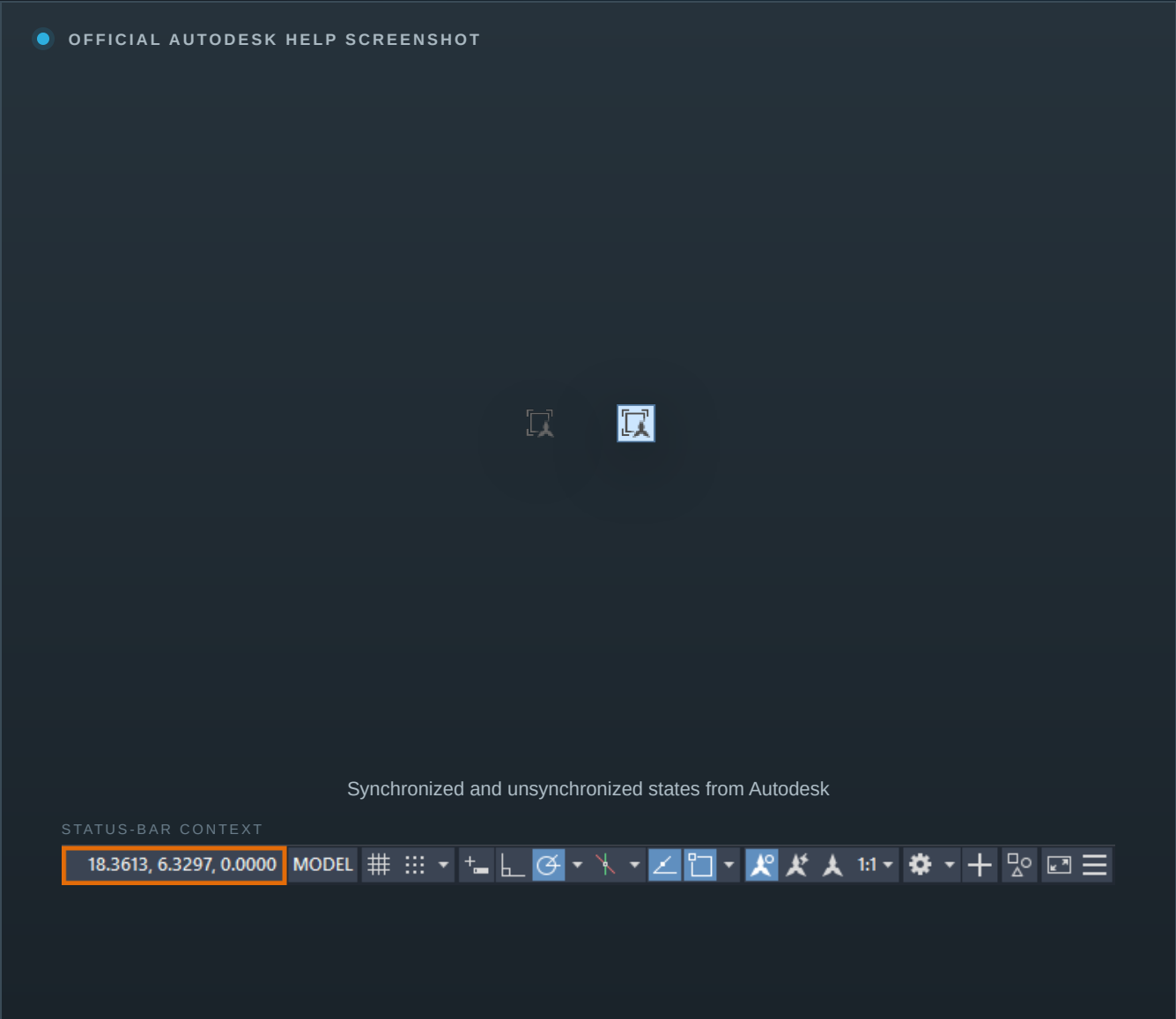
HOW IT BEHAVES

The icon changes when the two scales differ, making inconsistent annotation context visible at a glance.



ACCESS

Contextual control when a viewport is selected



Workspace Switching

Changes the active AutoCAD workspace and exposes workspace management commands.

HOW IT BEHAVES

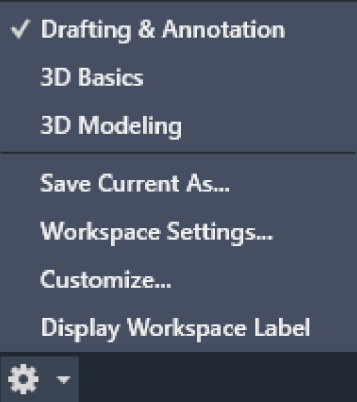
The menu switches among Drafting & Annotation, 3D Basics, and 3D Modeling and can save or customize a workspace.



ACCESS

WORKSPACE · WSCURRENT

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Workspace Switching menu from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Annotation Monitor

Displays badges on dimensions and leaders that have lost association with their geometry.

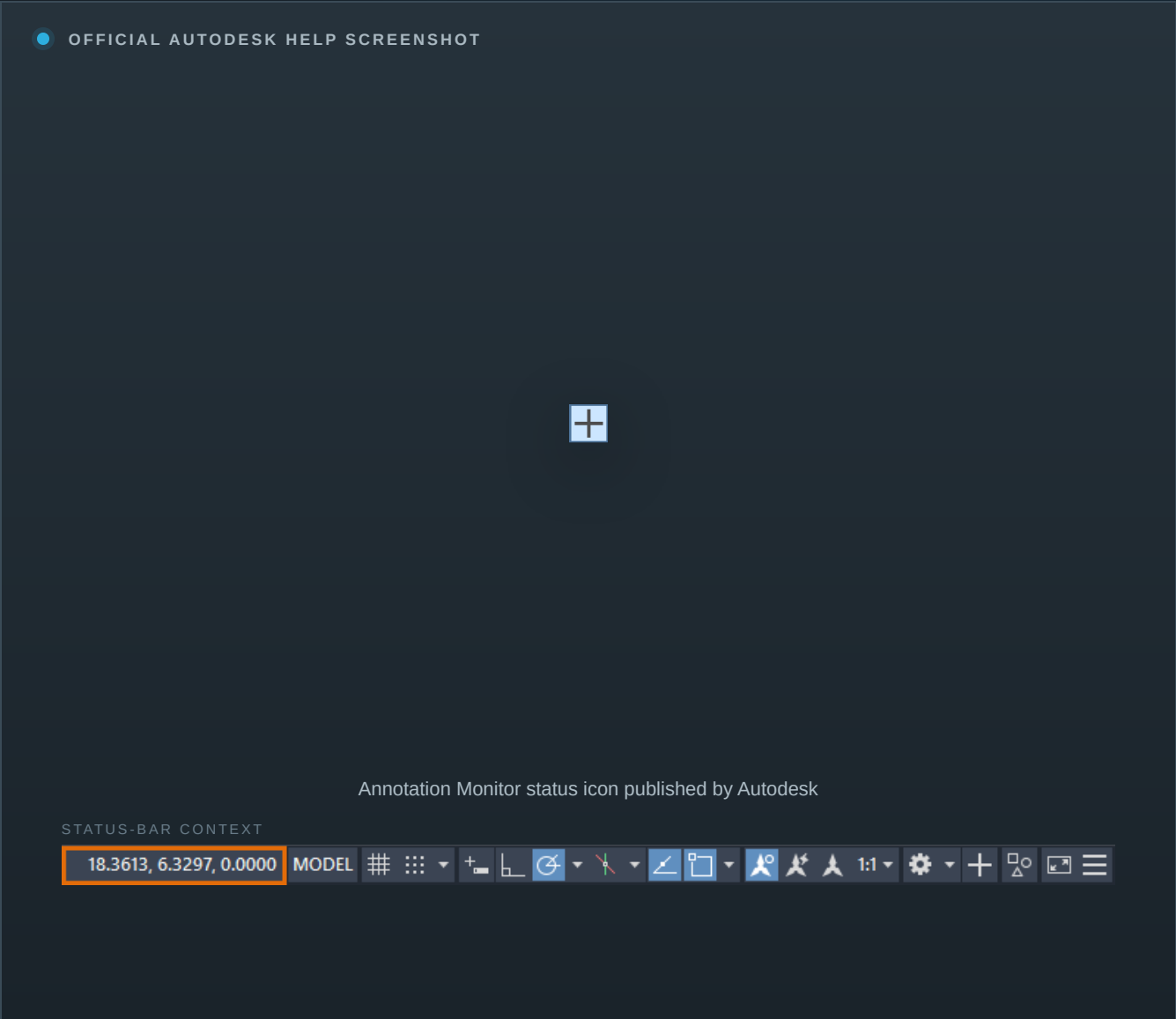
HOW IT BEHAVES

The monitor makes nonassociative annotations visible so they can be re-associated before documentation is issued.



ACCESS

ANNOMONITOR



Units

Displays the current drawing-unit format and opens unit configuration.

HOW IT BEHAVES

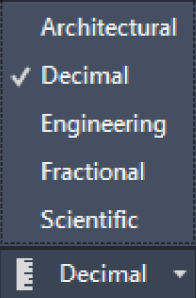
The flyout provides common formats such as Architectural, Decimal, Engineering, Fractional, and Scientific.



ACCESS

UNITS · Select the unit format

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Drawing-unit formats shown by Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Quick Properties

Displays a compact property panel when objects are selected.

HOW IT BEHAVES

It exposes the most useful properties near the drawing area without requiring the full Properties palette.



ACCESS

Ctrl+Shift+P · QPMODE

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Quick Properties status icon published by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Lock UI

Locks the position and size of toolbars, panels, palettes, and dockable windows.

HOW IT BEHAVES

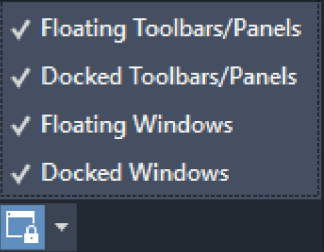
The flyout selects which UI classes remain fixed while preserving normal drawing interaction.



ACCESS

LOCKUI · Dropdown selects locked UI classes

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Lock UI menu from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Graphics Performance

Reports graphics configuration and provides access to hardware-acceleration settings.

HOW IT BEHAVES

Hardware acceleration uses the GPU for supported display effects and can be tuned when visual performance or compatibility requires it.



ACCESS

GRAPHICSCONFIG

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Graphics Performance status icon published by Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Clean Screen

Maximizes the drawing area by hiding most interface elements while retaining the command window.

HOW IT BEHAVES

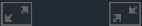
The status icon changes to a restore state so the ribbon, toolbars, and dockable windows can be brought back.



ACCESS

Ctrl+0 · CLEANSCREENON / CLEANSCREENOFF

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Clean Screen and restore states from Autodesk

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Isolate Objects

Temporarily hides selected objects or isolates them by hiding everything else.

HOW IT BEHAVES

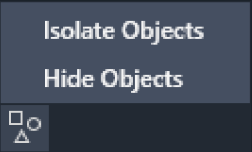
The menu also restores previously hidden objects, making focused editing reversible.



ACCESS

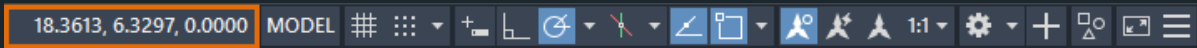
ISOLATEOBJECTS · HIDEOBJECTS · UNISOLATEOBJECTS

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Isolate Objects menu from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT



Customization

Chooses which status-bar controls are visible.

HOW IT BEHAVES

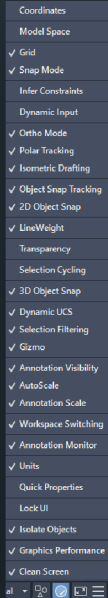
The rightmost three-line button opens a checklist. A check mark means the corresponding control is displayed.



ACCESS

Click the three horizontal lines at the far-right end

OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT



Status-bar Customization checklist from Autodesk Help

STATUS-BAR CONTEXT

18.3613, 6.3297, 0.0000

MODEL





Seven high-frequency toggles

F3	Object Snap
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F7	Grid Display
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F8	Orthomode
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F9	Snap Mode
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F10	Polar Tracking
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F11	Object Snap Tracking
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F12	Dynamic Input
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Ctrl+0	Clean Screen
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 OFFICIAL AUTODESK HELP SCREENSHOT

18.3613, 6.3297, 0.0000 MODEL

Mouse and keyboard controls change the same native drafting states.

Official Autodesk material only

01 Status Bar Quick Reference

Control names, descriptions, icons, menus, and contextual states.

<https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2025/ENU/AutoCAD-Core/files/GUID-E3B34B0A-EA98-45E9-937A-BF5FEF4152DB.htm>

02 The Status Bar

Enabled-state convention, settings access, customization, coordinates, and function keys.

<https://help.autodesk.com/cloudhelp/2024/ENU/AutoCAD-DidYouKnow/files/GUID-0E4DE630-C2D9-4C0B-889B-16774D8AB1EE.htm>

03 Control-specific Autodesk Help

Every capability slide links directly to its official detail topic. Visual files were downloaded from the image URLs embedded by Autodesk in the two pages above on 2026-09-04. No generated, traced, recreated, Kuubik, LibreCAD, or third-party images are included.

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